Northstar Academy | Course handbook

Fictional practice data

All academy names, policies and contact addresses in this document are invented for RAG exercises. Edition: October 2026.

Python Foundations

Python Foundations runs for 6 weeks. Classes meet Monday and Wednesday from 7:00 PM to 8:30 PM IST. The course fee is INR 4,800. It is intended for beginners; no previous programming experience is required. Learners need a laptop with Python installed.

Learning and assessment

The course covers variables, conditions, loops, functions, lists, dictionaries and reading text files. Learners submit four weekly assignments and one final project. To receive a completion certificate, a learner must attend at least 75 percent of sessions and score at least 60 out of 100 on the final project. Recordings remain available for 30 days after the course ends.

Northstar Academy | RAG course

RAG Starter

RAG Starter runs for 4 weeks. Classes meet Saturday from 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM IST. The course fee is INR 6,200. Learners must already understand Python functions, classes and lists. Completion of Python Foundations is helpful but is not mandatory.

Learning and assessment

The course covers document loading, chunking, embeddings, vector databases, retrieval and grounded LLM answers. Learners build a local document assistant. To receive a completion certificate, learners need at least 80 percent attendance and a final project score of at least 70 out of 100. Recordings remain available for 45 days after the course ends.

Project submission

The final RAG project is submitted within 7 calendar days after the last class. It must answer questions from supplied documents, show source pages and decline questions unsupported by the documents. An attractive user interface is optional. A working terminal application is sufficient.